

M. Cecilia Ramírez-Michelena

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics

mcramirezmichelena@gmail.com | +34-666-399-085 | Barcelona, open to relocation | EU & Mercosur work authorization

Professional Summary

Ph.D. candidate in Economics specializing in the economics of education, labor markets, and gender inequality, with experience designing survey instruments, implementing randomized evaluations, and analyzing administrative and international assessment data across Latin America, the United States, and Europe. Skilled at translating empirical research into policy-oriented outputs for national administrations, school districts, and international research networks, and at coordinating stakeholders from evidence design through field implementation.

Core Competencies: Economics of education, gender and labor economics, survey design and implementation, randomized field experiments, administrative and international assessment data, stakeholder and institutional coordination, monitoring and evaluation, technical and policy writing.

Professional Experience

Institut d'Economia de Barcelona, Universitat de Barcelona
Predoctoral Researcher and Instructor

01/2023 – Present
Barcelona, Spain

- Conduct applied research in education and labor economics using administrative microdata (educational and social security records) and international assessment data (PISA) with causal inference methods to study educational trajectories, gender inequality, and labor-market outcomes. Working papers presented at EALE, SEHO, and KU Leuven.
- Design and prepare the implementation of a school-based randomized information intervention in secondary schools in Catalonia, funded by the *Women and Science* Program at Paris Dauphine-PSL, aimed at reducing the gender gap in STEM. Lead day-to-day project development, including treatment design, survey design and implementation planning, school engagement, budget management, research assistant supervision, and coordination with schools and education stakeholders.

Education Policy Analytics Lab, College of Education, University of Washington
Predoctoral Researcher

09/2018 – 09/2019
Seattle, United States

- Worked in a research-practice partnership with Seattle Public Schools — the largest K–12 provider in Washington State — analyzing administrative data on teacher effectiveness, absenteeism, recruitment, and retention in high-poverty schools.
- Shaped empirical questions through ongoing dialogue with district executives, school administrators, union representatives, and program managers, keeping the analysis connected to operational priorities.
- Produced internal reports, technical notes, and presentations to communicate findings to senior district leadership and support evidence-informed planning.

Center for Research in Applied Economics, Universidad de Montevideo
Research Assistant and Field Leader

06/2015 – 07/2018
Montevideo, Uruguay

- Managed field implementation workstreams for randomized evaluations with vulnerable populations in Uruguay. Recruited, trained, and supervised more than 50 field workers and research assistants; designed and revised survey instruments and field protocols, supervised data collection, cleaned and validated survey data, conducted quantitative analysis, and prepared reports, research outputs, and practitioner-facing materials.
- Coordinated day-to-day field activities with ministries, municipal departments, hospitals, frontline providers, social workers, research assistants, and implementing partners, ensuring field procedures, data quality, and implementation constraints remained aligned with the evaluation design.

Education

Universitat de Barcelona, Barcelona, Spain

Ph.D. in Economics

Expected 09/2026

Dissertation: *Essays on gender inequality, educational choices, and labor-market pathways.*

Supervisors: Profs. Lúdia Farré and Andreu Arenas.

Visiting Doctoral Student, **Columbia University**, New York, United States

Fall 2026

Visiting Doctoral Student, **Paris School of Economics**, Paris, France

June 2026

University of Washington , Seattle, United States	
M.Ed. in Educational Foundations, Leadership, and Policy Studies	2021
Specialization in <i>Organizational and Policy Studies</i>	
M.A. in Economics	2021
Universidad de Montevideo , Montevideo, Uruguay	
M.A. in Economics	2020
B.A. in Economics	2016
B.A. in Management and Business Administration	2016

Grants & Fellowships

Fellowships	
Dr. Joan Guinovart Fellowship, Societat Econòmica Barcelonesa d'Amics del País (2026).	
Doctoral Fellowship, Fundación Ramón Areces (2023–2026).	
Doctoral Fellowship, Generalitat de Catalunya (2023).	
Graduate Fellowship, University of Washington (2018–2020).	
Fulbright Scholarship for Graduate Studies, Fulbright Commission (2018–2020).	
Research Scholarship, Universidad de Montevideo (2016–2018).	
Research Grants	
Women and Science Program, Paris Dauphine–PSL University – PI: Prof. Lúdia Farré. EUR 10,000 (2024).	

Teaching Experience & Student Supervision

Universitat de Barcelona – Instructor and B.A. Thesis Advisor, Department of Economics	Spring 2024 – Present
IFSA Barcelona – Lecturer	Winter 2026
University of Washington – Instructor, Department of Spanish and Portuguese Studies	Fall 2020 – Spring 2021
Universidad de Montevideo – Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics	Fall 2014 – Spring 2015

Technical Skills & Languages

Tools	Stata; R; Python; Microsoft Office; LaTeX; Git/GitHub.
Data	Administrative data, survey data, randomized evaluation data, international assessment data (PISA) used for cross-country benchmarking, panel data, data cleaning, and policy-oriented outputs.
Outputs	Policy briefs; evaluation summaries; literature reviews; analytical reports; implementation memos; training materials; stakeholder presentations.
Languages	Spanish native; English fluent; Catalan intermediate; French basic.

Selected Research

- Abilities and Career Choices: Addressing the Gender Gap in STEM Fields. With A. Arenas and L. Farré. Working Paper. Presented at BRIDGE Economics of Education Workshop (KU Leuven) and SEHO Annual Meeting, 2025.
- Educational Gains from School Electrification in Rural Areas. With M. Blanco and N. D’Agosti. Working Paper. Presented at European Association of Labour Economists (EALE) and BSE, 2024.
- The Evolution of the Child Penalty and the Gender Wage Gap in Spain. With A. Arenas and L. Farré. Working Paper.
- Strategies to Increase the Take-up of Social Benefits: Evidence from a Field Experiment. With A. Cid, J.M. Cabrera, and M. Blanco. Working Paper.
- Tablets for Deeply Disadvantaged Older Adults: Challenges in Long-term Care Facilities. With A. Cid, R. Sotelo, and M. Leguisamo. *International Journal of Human-Computer Studies* (2020).